

Usability - S2 2025

Submission 2 - Storyboarding and Low-Fidelity Prototypes (25%, Individual Work)

Overview

Designing and developing an application or website can be costly in terms of time and money. To avoid wasting a lot of these resources on a final product that does not meet the user's needs or has usability problems, it is worth creating storyboards and low-fidelity prototypes.

Storyboards can help you understand the context in which a user might be interacting with your product, as well as their thoughts and emotional response to the interaction. Low-fidelity sketches of a prototype allow you to come up with a variety of design ideas quickly and cheaply, and refine them before putting a lot of work into a high-fidelity prototype.

During this assignment, consider the wide variety of different features, commonly found in mobile apps, that may be useful to provide an engaging user experience. For example:

- Use the device's camera to capture or scan
- Perform a search on the Internet
- Use a map to show the location of something
- Assign a rating or write a review
- Create and update a user profile
- Share content as a link or image
- Earn and keep track of daily points
- Get recommendations based on usage
- Send messages to other users

Having collected user data, performed analysis of this data and completed your personas, user stories and new requirements for Submission 1, you will use what you have learned to guide you through the process of creating storyboards and then developing some low-fidelity prototypes. This is an individual assignment.

1. User Stories

Select 2 user stories from submission 1 along with their accompanying persona (these can be from any group member's submission but should be user stories that were prioritised as either **Must** or **Should**). You may make minor updates to the selected stories if necessary, with a brief written justification for any changes made.

2. Storyboarding

Draw **2 storyboards** (one for each selected user story). Make sure each storyboard:

- Makes use of a specific persona (include the persona's name in the storyboard).
- Depicts a specific user story (the goal should be clear in the storyboard).
- Depicts the narrative using 4 to 6 frames with visuals that you have drawn.
- Has a brief text description under each visual. These descriptions should be meaningful, considering users' emotions/thoughts.

The storyboard can depict a successful or unsuccessful attempt at completing the goal. Consider who the persona is and present a realistic sequence of events.

In addition, you must also consider accessibility and inclusivity. **At least one of your storyboards must depict a user who has an accessibility consideration that impacts their experience using the app (i.e. permanent, temporary or situational).**

Additional reading: <https://www.nngroup.com/articles/storyboards-visualize-ideas/>

Storyboards must be hand-drawn, either on paper (submit a clear scan or photograph) or using a digital tool for drawing (ie. lines, basic shapes, text). Visuals constructed using AI-generated content or images downloaded from online sources will not be accepted.

3. Kanban Board with Acceptance Criteria

Now you have a good understanding of your users, and the problem you are trying to solve, and have created some storyboards to illustrate the requirements. Next, you will develop acceptance criteria and produce some prototype screens of your proposed solution:

- List the acceptance criteria, using the Kanban format as practiced in the lecture and applied classes, for the user stories you chose for your storyboards.
- Your kanban board will have the following columns, with each user story as a separate row in the board.

User Stories	To Do	Doing	Done

4. Low Fidelity Prototype Screens with Annotations

Create sketches of **3 low-fidelity prototype screens** relevant to the most important/relevant acceptance criteria. The screens must show the implementation of some acceptance criteria

from the user stories you selected in the previous task. For example, (1) the app's "*Home*" screen, (2) a "*Search Results*" screen, and so on. Assume the user is already logged in; do not sketch a sign-up/sign-in screen.

- A minimum of **3 acceptance criteria** must be implemented **per user story** (though you may implement more) across your three screens.
- Note that criteria belonging to 1 user story can be implemented across more than one screen.
- When you have completed your sketches, update your Kanban board to show which criteria were implemented in the 'Done' column.

In addition to considering general design and usability principles, your prototype must consider accessible and inclusive design.

- Nominate **3 of Norman's Design Principles** and **3 Accessibility Principles (Perceivable, Operable and Understandable)** and annotate your prototype sketches with labels to show where they have been applied. These should be spread evenly throughout your screens (i.e. each screen should have one Norman's Principle and one WCAG).
 - The annotation does not need to describe the implementation - just label the highlighted feature with the name of the principle. For example:
 - Norman's Principle: "**Feedback**" or "**Natural Mapping**"
 - Accessibility Principle: "**Perceivable**" or "**Operable**"

Sketches must be hand-drawn, either on paper (submit a clear scan or photograph) or using a digital tool for drawing (ie. lines, basic shapes, text). Visuals constructed using AI-generated content or images found online will not be accepted.

Sketches must be clear and well-proportioned, with an appropriate level of detail for a low-fidelity prototype to convey each screen's purpose.

Do not create more than 3 screens in total. Any screens over this limit (and their associated annotations/justifications of theories and principles) will not be marked.

5. Report

Write a brief report explaining the most important decisions you have made when designing your prototype. For each screen you must have:

- A heading with the screen's unique number and name.
- List the user story (or stories) each screen is intended to address.
- Briefly explain how the annotated Norman Principle or Accessibility Principle has been implemented in the design of each screen (about 75 words recommended to explain each principle for 1 screen, for a total of 150 words per screen).

- Conclusion (up to 150 words)
 - Briefly conclude the report by considering the limitations of low-fidelity prototyping and identifying 2 goals for your upcoming high-fidelity prototype.
- As tutors will not be referring to previous submissions while marking Submission 2, please include the relevant personas from Submission 1 in an Appendix at the end of your Submission 2 document.

Format of the deliverables

Consider how you would present your materials to a potential client. Your submission must contain the following:

- Title Page
- Table of Contents
- Introduction (up to 150 words)
- 2 Selected User Stories (and justification for changes, if applicable)
- 2 Storyboards (including 1 storyboard considering an impairment)
- 2 Kanban Boards (1 for each user story) showing proposed and completed Acceptance Criteria for
- Low-Fidelity Prototypes (3 screens in total, annotated)
- Design Report
 - Applied theory for prototype screens (up to 150 words per screen)
- Conclusion (up to 150 words)
- Appendix
 - Relevant Personas (from submission 1, based on selected user stories)

Deliverables should be professionally formatted - present them as if you were giving them to a potential client.

The name of the report file should follow this format: **FIT5152-Sub2-Applied#-YourName** (e.g., **FIT5152-Sub2-Applied01-AshKetchum**).

Submission Due: Friday 19th September, at 11:55pm.

Assessment Policies

Use of Generative AI Tools

In this assessment, you may only use generative AI tools to generate photos to use as profile photos in user personas. Any use of generative AI must be acknowledged by specifying the tools and prompts used (see [Learn HQ](#)).

- Clearly identify the part of your work where Generative AI was used.
- Include a reference link to the AI tool that was used.
- Include the prompt that was entered to generate the output.
- Explain how you modified the original output before submission.

Use of Generative AI tools for other purposes and use of Generative AI tools without proper acknowledgement is a breach of academic integrity.

Plagiarism and academic integrity

Plagiarism occurs when students fail to acknowledge that the ideas of others are being used. This includes when:

- Other people's work is used in whole or part without citation/reference.
- Other people's work is paraphrased or modified without acknowledgement.
- AI-generated output is presented as your own work without acknowledgement.

It is your responsibility to [maintain academic integrity in your work](#) and understand the [procedures and penalties](#) that apply to intentional and unintentional breaches of integrity.

Submission of deliverables to Moodle

All assessed work must be uploaded to Moodle using the provided submission link. Where practicable, submissions will be scanned using a similarity checking tool, such as TurnItIn.

Submission of assessable work using other methods (email, Google Drive, etc.) will not be accepted unless specific instructions to do so are provided in the assignment brief.

Late Submissions

Each day, or part thereof, that an assessment task is overdue, a penalty of 5% of the available total marks applies. Assessment tasks submitted more than seven days after the due date will receive a mark of zero and may not receive feedback.

All extension and special consideration requests must be submitted using the [online extension request form](#). Submitting an application for an extension or special consideration does not guarantee that the extension will be approved, so you should continue to work on your assessment and submit it as soon as you are able to.